

7-DAY THAILAND ESCAPE

Bangkok + Koh Samui • relaxed pace • temples • local food • tropical fruit • mango sticky rice

Traveller style: Comfortable, unhurried, food-focused. Keep mornings for temples and markets, afternoons flexible for heat or rain, and avoid changing hotels every night.	Weather strategy: Rain can disrupt outdoor plans, so keep one flexible day and choose the Gulf coast rather than Phuket if travelling during the wetter months.
DAY 1 — ARRIVE IN BANGKOK	Settle into a comfortable hotel around Riverside or Old Town. Keep the first day easy: wander nearby, get a Thai massage, then eat at a local market. Eat: grilled chicken, som tam, fresh pineapple, watermelon and a first mango sticky rice.
DAY 2 — OLD BANGKOK TEMPLES + RIVER	Start early at Wat Pho and Wat Arun , when it is cooler and less crowded. Take a Chao Phraya river boat between areas rather than sitting in traffic. Lunch: boat noodles or pad kra pao. Afternoon: café/food-hall break if rain arrives. Evening: Chinatown (Yaowarat) for street food and tropical fruit.
DAY 3 — MARKETS, FRUIT & AYUTTHAYA OPTION	Morning visit to a fresh market for Thai fruit: Nam Dok Mai mango, mangosteen, rambutan, longan and dragon fruit. If the forecast is dry, take a relaxed day trip to Ayutthaya for historic temple ruins; if rain looks likely, stay in Bangkok for museums, cafés and a long lunch instead. Dinner: khao man gai or tom yum.
DAY 4 — FLY TO KOH SAMUI • SLOW DOWN	Fly Bangkok → Koh Samui and check into a comfortable beachside hotel. No ambitious sightseeing. Have lunch near the hotel, swim or relax by the pool, then watch sunset if conditions allow. Food: southern Thai curry, grilled seafood, coconut water and chilled mango.
DAY 5 — SAMUI TEMPLE + LOCAL FOOD DAY	Visit Big Buddha and Wat Plai Laem in the morning. Return before the hottest part of the day. Spend the afternoon at the beach, pool or a spa. Eat: khao soi or local southern curry, grilled prawns, sticky rice with ripe mango and fresh coconut.
DAY 6 — FLEXIBLE ISLAND DAY	Make this the weather-dependent day. Dry weather: choose a gentle boat/snorkelling trip or explore a quieter beach. Rainy weather: sleep in, have a long breakfast, get a massage, visit cafés and do a Thai cooking class. Finish with a relaxed local dinner and a tropical fruit platter.
DAY 7 — MANGO BREAKFAST + RETURN	Slow final morning. Have mango + sticky rice , Thai coffee and fresh fruit, then fly back to Bangkok for your onward flight. Keep the final day light so a delayed ferry/flight or bad weather does not wreck the schedule.
Rain-proof rule: Do outdoor sights before 11am where possible. Keep afternoons flexible and never build the trip around a single boat day. For a September trip, Bangkok is workable but wet; the Gulf islands are generally a better beach bet than Phuket, though rain is never guaranteed away. Best food checklist ■ Nam Dok Mai mango ■ Mango sticky rice ■ Young coconut ■ Mangosteen + rambutan ■ Boat noodles / pad kra pao ■ Southern Thai curry	

Pace: 2 bases only • Transport: 1 domestic flight • Ideal trip length: 6 nights / 7 days • Book flexible/refundable accommodation when travelling in wetter months.